

Module 4: Biodiversity, evolution and disease

In this module the learners study the biodiversity of organisms; how they are classified and the ways in which biodiversity can be measured. It serves as an introduction to ecology, emphasising practical techniques and an appreciation of the need to maintain biodiversity. The learners also gain an understanding of the variety of organisms that are pathogenic and the way in which plants and animals have evolved defences to deal with disease. The

impact of the evolution of pathogens on the treatment of disease is also considered.

The relationships between organisms are studied, considering variation, evolution and phylogeny.

Learners are expected to apply knowledge, understanding and other skills developed in this module to new situations and/or to solve related problems.